These symptoms are common during pregnancy. There is no need for any special treatment, it will subside. But any of the above symptoms interferes in normal routine life then they need to contact the care provider.

Advice the antenatal mother in the above components to follow up till the next visit to the hospital.

Preparation for Birth

During the last few months of pregnancy the mother will be taught about the following

- Recognizing signs of true versus false labor
- When to go to the hospital
- Approaches to pain control
- Things to bring for labor and after
- Planning for children at home
- Care of the newborn

5.11 POST NATAL CARE

Introduction

More than 60% of maternal deaths take place during postpartum period. The first 48 hours are most crucial because Most maternal and neonatal complications are occur during this period. The puerperium is the period beginning after delivery and ending when the woman's body has returned as closely as possible to its prepregnant state.

- The period lasts approximately 6 weeks. The postnatal care starts after the childbirth to 6 weeks

Aims of Postnatal Care

- Prevention of sepsis at placental site
- Newborn care
- Initiation of breast feeding

Nursing Assessment

Immediate Postpartum Assessment. The first 1 hour after delivery of the placenta (fourth stage of labor) is the critical period; post partum hemorrhage is most likely to occur at this time.

Components of Postnatal Care

1. Postnatal check up includes Pulse, BP, RR. Temp and Pallor. Monitor vital signs every 4 hours during the first 24 hours, then every 8 to 12 hours
2. BUBBLE-HE is a acronym used to denote the components of the postpartum maternal nursing assessment.
   - B: Breast
   - U: Uterus
   - B: Bladder
   - B: Bowels
   - L: Lochia
   - E: Episiotomy and perineum
   - H: Homan's
   - E: Emotional status

B- Breast: Assess for breast engorgement and condition of nipples if breast-feeding.

- Size, Shape, Firmness, Redness, Symmetry
- Check the Breasts for - nodules, lumps
- Check the Nipples - assess for eversion, flat, inverted, cracking, bleeding, pain, blisters

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